

01

LAND YOUR FIRST AI CLIENT · THE PACK

THE CORE PLAYBOOK

From Zero To Your First Signed Client

The actual step by step. Not theory, not motivation. What to do, in order, until money hits your account.

00 The only reason people fail at this

It's not skill. It's not the tech. People fail to land a first client because they do everything except the one thing that gets a client: talking to businesses about their problems. They build, they tweak, they watch videos, they redesign their logo for the fourth time. Anything but outreach.

So here's the deal for this whole pack. The bottleneck is never "I don't know enough." It's "I haven't talked to enough owners yet." Every doc in here exists to get you into more real conversations and to stop you from choking when you're in one.

THE ONE COMMITMENT

You do not get to build anything, tweak anything, or "get ready" until you've done your outreach for the day. Reps with real businesses is the only activity that moves you toward a client. Everything else is comfortable procrastination dressed up as work.

If you internalize just that, you're ahead of most people who buy something like this and never talk to a soul. Now let's get you a client.

01 Pick who you're going after

If you try to sell "AI" to "businesses," you'll sell nothing. The people who land clients fast pick a narrow lane and own it. Narrow makes everything easier: you know their problems, your outreach sounds like you get it, and referrals compound inside one industry.

The kind of business that actually buys

You want businesses that already spend money to get customers and have real problems money can fix. The sweet spot: local service businesses run by an owner who's busy, not corporate, and feels the pain personally.

- **Owner-operated.** One person makes the decision. No committee, no procurement, no six-month cycle.
- **Already spending on getting customers.** Ads running, reviews stacking up. Money is already moving, you're just plugging leaks.
- **Busy and stretched.** The owner is doing five jobs. Time and dropped leads are real pain, not theoretical.
- **Good reputation, weak digital game.** Great reviews but a dead website or unanswered DMs. That gap is your whole pitch.

Think trades and local services: electricians, HVAC, plumbers, roofers, landscapers, auto shops, pest control. They're everywhere, they've got money, and most of them are getting ignored by agencies chasing sexier clients.

YOUR MOVE

Pick ONE industry to start. Not three. One. Write it down. Every message, every call, every bit of research for the next two weeks is aimed at that one type of business. You can expand later. Right now, narrow wins.

02 Find them and spot the opening

Once you've got a lane, you need a list of real businesses and a reason to reach out to each one. The reason matters. Generic outreach gets ignored. "I noticed X specific thing about your business" gets a reply.

Where to find them

- **Google Maps.** Search your industry plus a city. Every result is a lead with reviews, a website (or not), and a phone number sitting right there.
- **Facebook / Instagram.** Businesses running ads are literally telling you they spend money on leads. Check if the page they send people to is any good.
- **Their reviews vs their website.** 200 five-star reviews and a website that looks like 2009? That's the loudest buying signal there is.

What you're looking for (the opening)

Before you reach out, find the specific gap. This is what makes your message land instead of getting deleted.

- No website, or a broken/ugly/slow one.
- Running ads that point to a weak page that won't convert.
- Tons of reviews but no way to book or contact easily.
- DMs and messages that clearly go unanswered.
- No after-hours anything. Call at 7pm, straight to voicemail forever.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Your opening line is going to reference the exact gap you spotted. "Saw you're running ads but the page they land on doesn't have a way to book" hits a nerve. "I do AI for businesses" gets ignored. The research IS the pitch.

YOUR MOVE

Build a list of 20 businesses in your lane. For each one, write down the single biggest gap you spotted. That list plus those gaps is your outreach fuel for the week.

03 Reach out (this is the whole game)

This is where everyone freezes. Don't. The goal of outreach is not to sell. It's to start a conversation and book a short call. Lower the bar in your own head and it gets a lot easier to actually hit send.

The three channels, ranked

1. **Cold call.** Scariest, fastest, highest hit rate for local owners. They pick up, you talk, you book a call or you don't. Minutes, not days.
2. **DM / Instagram.** Great for businesses active on social. Feels casual, lower pressure, easy to reference their content.
3. **Email.** Easiest to send, easiest to ignore. Works as follow-up and volume, weakest on its own.

The exact words to use for each are in **Doc 02, the Outreach Swipe File**. Don't write your own from scratch when you're starting. Use the templates, make them yours after you've sent a hundred.

THE NUMBER THAT MATTERS

Set a daily minimum of outreach before you do anything else. Pick a real number and hit it every single day no matter what. Most people who "tried outreach" sent nine messages total and quit. The ones who win send that many before breakfast.

Handling the "no" and the silence

Most won't reply. That's normal, not failure. Follow up two or three times, spaced out, then move on. The fortune is in the follow-up, most deals come after the first message got ignored. Don't take silence personally, it's just volume.

04 Run the call

You booked a call. Now don't blow it by pitching. The best sales calls are 80% them talking. Your job is to understand their problem better than they do, then show them you can fix it.

The shape of a call that closes

1. **Build rapport, fast.** Real, not fake. Reference their business, their reviews, something specific.
2. **Ask about their problem.** Get them talking about what's not working. The more they say it out loud, the more they sell themselves.
3. **Reflect it back.** "So if I'm hearing you right, you're spending on ads but leads slip through after hours." Now they know you get it.
4. **Present the fix.** Short. Tie it directly to what they just told you. Not a feature dump.
5. **Talk price with confidence.** Don't flinch, don't apologize, don't discount before they even push back.
6. **Close on a next step.** Send the proposal, book the follow-up, get the deposit. Never end with "let me know."

The exact discovery questions and how to handle "it's too expensive," "let me think about it," and every other objection are in **Doc 03, the Sales Call Cheat Sheet**. Have it open during the call.

YOUR MOVE

Before your first real call, do one practice run out loud. Talk through the whole shape above to a friend, or a wall. Sounds dumb, works. The first time you say your pitch shouldn't be to a paying prospect.

05 Price it, close it, deliver

Here's where beginners bleed out. They either charge \$200 out of fear or freeze completely and never send a number. Both kill the deal. You need to price like it's worth something, because it is.

Don't undercharge

Charging too little doesn't just cost you money, it costs you credibility. Owners assume cheap means bad. A real price signals a real service. The full breakdown of how to structure and price a first offer is in **Doc 04, the Pricing & Offer Guide**.

Closing the deal

- **Get a deposit.** Half up front is standard and it filters out tire-kickers. Someone who won't pay a deposit was never going to pay.
- **Put it in writing.** A simple agreement. Scope, price, timeline, payment. Protects both of you.
- **Set the expectation.** What you'll deliver, by when. Under-promise, over-deliver.

The first client is worth more than the money

Your first client gives you three things worth more than the check: proof you can do it, a case study to close the next ten, and a referral source. Treat them like gold. Over-deliver so hard they can't shut up about you. One thrilled first client is the foundation of everything after.

THE WHOLE THING IN ONE LINE

Pick a lane, build a list, reach out every single day, book calls, understand the problem, price with a straight face, close, over-deliver. That's it. It's not complicated. It's just uncomfortable, and the discomfort is the job.

NEXT

Now go open the **Swipe File**.

The Playbook told you what to do. Doc 02 gives you the exact words to say so you never stare at a blank message again. Then Doc 03 for the call, Doc 04 for the price.